

Let us know

Dear Sir,
Earlier the customer service team used to send an e-mail to all Digit subscribers with details on when their magazine was couriered every month. This was most useful, but for some strange reason has stopped. Can you please start the e-mail notification once again?
Sandeep
Via e-mail

Dear Sandeep,
We were updating the backend subscriber database and hence could not send out notification e-mails for a couple of months. The service has been resumed from this month and will continue as before. To ensure that we have your correct e-mail address, write to narmita_shetty@issultha.com.

digit

Game on

Dear Vinit,
I wonder what keeps the global \$20-billion gaming console industry from coming into the Indian market. The next-generation gaming consoles from Nintendo, Sony and Microsoft are doing brisk business everywhere except India. I believe Indian gamers too would love to own these new gaming machines. Plus consoles can arrest the nagging (and expensive) problem of gamers having to upgrade their PC graphics card every six months to keep up with the latest games.
Priyanshu Kakati
Via e-mail



Dear Priyanshu,
India is not a potential market for console games for a number of reasons. Console makers lose sizeable amounts of money on every unit of hardware they sell, which is recovered via software sales over a period of time. With piracy being a big problem in India, console makers cannot hope to recover their money and hence will be forced to price the hardware at a premium. Compound this with the duties that will be levied on these gaming consoles and you'll land up with prices that will be quite out of reach for most consumers.

Only when these console makers have recovered the R&D costs of their hardware will they turn to less lucrative markets like India, but that will involve a long waiting time for Indian gamers hungry to get their hands on these new game machines.

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Selling hype

Dear Vinit,
I quite agree with your August editorial 'One Step Forward, Two Steps Back', but one very important point that I wish to highlight is that innovations by manufacturers drive society to improve. Consider this: Windows 3.1 runs on any old 386-based computer, but if Windows 95 had not been developed, how would Intel or any other microprocessor company be able to sell faster and more advanced processors? Windows XP chokes a sub-500 MHz Celeron CPU, but Windows Me will run quite happily on it. The point is, everybody is trying to go higher and, in turn, they compel other manufacturers to make better products. And it's not that there is any real need. There are very few things that can be done on XP, but not on Me. Then do you need XP? The simple answer is yes. Because of Windows XP, there is a Pentium 4, which makes RDRAM useful, and which in turn facilitates the need for newer chipsets and motherboards. All this translates into a lot of jobs for people and yes, money!
Hrishikesh Thite
Via e-mail

Dear Hrishikesh,
There's no denying that innovations are needed for our society to improve and grow. The irony is that there is so much clutter today that manufacturers and marketers need to hype up their innovations in order to attract customers in the first place!

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Web of confusion

Sir,
In the comparison between Adobe GoLive 6.0 and Macromedia Dreamweaver MX (Digit, July 2002), you have mentioned that GoLive uses relative links, which is bad. When you upload your files to the server, you would obviously want relative links, so GoLive is a winner as far as I'm concerned!
Premshree Pillai
Via e-mail

Dear Premshree,
You've misread the little note on GoLive. The problem was that when you created a new page in GoLive, it used relative links from where GoLive assumed the page would be saved and not where the page was actually saved. Thus, all the links were wrong. I'm sure you wouldn't want this situation when uploading to your server.

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Your vote counts

Q. Which amongst these four comparison tests would you like covered in an upcoming issue of Digit?

DVD-ROM drives	Input devices	PC cabinets	MFDs
36%	15%	23%	26%

Look out for a DVD-ROM drive shootout in a forthcoming issue!

This month's question:

"Which of these would you prefer covered in greater detail?"

■ Linux ■ Gaming ■ Mobile computing

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote on it